Generated from the competition table

2021 Men's Ballon d'Or

Everything the Men's Ballon d'Or table records about 2021, with the winner linked to their full award history and their national team linked to its own record.

Winner	National team	Ceremony date
Lionel Messi	Argentina	29 November 2021

The story of this edition

Lionel Messi (Argentina) won the 2021 Ballon d'Or the same year he captained Argentina to the Copa América title.

← Previous edition (PDF)
2020

Next edition (PDF) →
2022

All Men's Ballon d'Or editions →

📚 References & review

Status: verified

Last reviewed:31 October 2026

- Official winners and rankings (https://ballondor.com/all-rankings)
- Official homepage (https://ballondor.com/)
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (source 1 of 5) (https://www.rsssf.org/miscellaneous/europa-poy65.html)
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (source 2 of 5) (https://www.britannica.com/topic/Ballon-dOr)

- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (source 3 of 5) (https://www.jeuneafrique.com/381505/politique/jour-26-decembre-1995-george-weah-elu-ballon-dor/)
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (source 4 of 5) (https://www.voanews.com/)
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (source 5 of 5) (https://www.uefa.com/uefachampionsleague/news/)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 1 of 9) (https://www.si.com/soccer/what-is-the-kopa-trophy-past-winners-nominees-2025)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 2 of 9) (https://www.90min.com/what-is-kopa-trophy-past-winners-nominees)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 3 of 9) (https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/kopa-trophy.htm)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 4 of 9) (https://www.sportsdunia.com/football-analysis/list-of-kopa-trophy-winners)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 5 of 9) (https://www.chaseyoursport.com/football/list-of-kopa-trophy-winners/8061)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 6 of 9) (https://www.givemesport.com/every-winner-kopa-trophy-ranked/)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 7 of 9) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Kopa_Trophy)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 8 of 9) (https://www.fcbarcelona.com/en/football/first-team/news/4367534/lamine-yamal-retains-kopa-trophy/featured)
- Kopa Trophy winners (added 2026-08-31, intensive run): a new "Kopa Trophy (source 9 of 9) (https://www.tntsports.co.uk/football/ballon-d-or/2025/lamine-yamal-retains-kopa-trophy-for-best-young-player-vicky-lopez-takes-inaugural-womens-prize_sto23224406/story.shtml)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 1 of 11) (https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/yashin-trophy.htm)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 2 of 11) (https://www.premierleague.com/en/news/4420829/donnarumma-and-gyokeres-win-awards-at-2025-ballon-dor)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 3 of 11) (https://goaltheball.com/yashin-trophy-winners-list/)

- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 4 of 11) (https://www.fotmob.com/el/news/x3syvn394xhu179pkuk2k9k4y/ballon-d'or-2019-liverpool-goalkeeper-alisson-wins-inaugural-yachine-trophy)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 5 of 11) (https://www.goal.com/en-ca/lists/aston-villa-and-argentina-goalkeeper-emiliano-martinez-retains-yashin-trophy-as-world-s-best-goalkeeper-in-2024/blt47f77564722f26b5)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 6 of 11) (https://fr.wikipedia.org/wiki/Troph%C3%A9e_Yachine)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 7 of 11) (https://www.footmercato.net/a7278391082899020163-ballon-dor-2025-gianluigi-donnarumma-remporte-le-trophee-yachine)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 8 of 11) (https://www.realmadrid.com/en-US/news/football/first-team/special-features/courtois-yashin-trophy-winner-2022)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 9 of 11) (https://www.tntsports.co.uk/football/ballon-d-or/2022/ballon-dor-2022-thibaut-courtois-wins-yashin-trophy-for-best-goalkeeper-after-real-madrid-heroics-la_sto9191911/story.shtml)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 10 of 11) (https://www.90min.com/posts/emiliano-martinez-wins-2023-yashin-trophy)
- Yashin Trophy winners (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Yashin (source 11 of 11) (https://www.besoccer.com/new/emiliano-martinez-wins-back-to-back-yachine-trophy-awards-1335839)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 1 of 10) (https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/striker-of-the-year.htm)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 2 of 10) (https://www.90min.com/what-is-gerd-muller-trophy-past-winners-nominees)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 3 of 10) (https://www.gamereactor.eu/what-is-the-gerd-muller-trophy-and-who-will-win-this-year-at-ballon-dor-2025-1605433/)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 4 of 10) (https://www.arsenal.com/news/viktor-gyokeres-wins-gerd-muller-trophy)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 5 of 10) (https://fcbayern.com/en/news/2022/10/muller-trophy-for-year%E2%80%99s-best-striker-awarded-for-the-first-time-at-the-ballon-dor-ceremony)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 6 of 10) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Gerd_M%C3%BCller_Trophy)

- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 7 of 10) (https://www.bavarianfootballworks.com/2022/10/18/23409746/robert-lewandowski-striker-award-2022-gerd-muller-fc-barcelona-bayern-munich-alum-haaland-benzema)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 8 of 10) (https://www.fcbarcelona.com/en/news/2858120/lewandowski-wins-inaugural-gerd-muller-trophy/featured)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 9 of 10) (https://www.fourfourtwo.com/features/ballon-dor-what-is-the-gerd-muller-trophy)
- Gerd Müller Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, forty-ninth intensive run): a (source 10 of 10) (https://sports.yahoo.com/article/won-gerd-muller-trophy-2025-201726350.html)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 1 of 9) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Johan_Cruyff_Trophy_(France_Football))
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 2 of 9) (https://www.goal.com/en-us/lists/carlo-ancelotti-men-s-coach-of-year-ballon-d-or-ceremony-xabi-alonso-pep-guardiola/blt4f9630905d966f8d)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 3 of 9) (https://www.besoccer.com/new/real-madrid-boss-ancelotti-wins-men-s-johan-cruyff-trophy-1335838)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 4 of 9) (https://www.beinsports.com/en-us/soccer/articles-video/ancelotti-is-the-best-coach-of-the-year-2024-10-28)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 5 of 9) (https://www.managingmadrid.com/2024/10/28/24282158/carlo-ancelotti-wins-coach-of-the-year-award)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 6 of 9) (https://sports.yahoo.com/article/psg-head-coach-luis-enrique-193800045.html)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 7 of 9) (https://www.besoccer.com/new/luis-enrique-wins-2025-johan-cruyff-trophy-for-world-s-best-coach-1374497)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 8 of 9) (https://www.caughtoffside.com/2025/09/22/ballon-dor-2025-luis-enrique-best-coach/)
- Johan Cruyff Trophy winners (added 2026-09-02, fifty-first intensive run) (source 9 of 9) (https://tribuna.com/en/news/2025-09-22-luis-enrique-wins-johan-cruyff-trophy-at-2025-ballon-dor/)

- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 1 of 11) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/S%C3%B3crates_Award)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 2 of 11) (https://www.peace-sport.org/socrates-award/)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 3 of 11) (https://www.peace-sport.org/news/the-senegalese-sadio-mane-becomes-the-first-winner-of-the-socrates-award-at-the-2022-ballon-dor-ceremony/)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 4 of 11) (https://fcbayern.com/en/news/2022/10/sadio-mane-the-inaugural-winner-of-the-socrates-award)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 5 of 11) (https://www.peace-sport.org/news/vinicius-junior-wins-socrates-award-at-the-2023-ballon-dor-ceremony/)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 6 of 11) (https://www.besoccer.com/new/vinicius-wins-socrates-2023-award-for-his-humanitarian-work-1287586)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 7 of 11) (https://www.90min.com/what-is-socrates-award-past-winners-nominees)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 8 of 11) (https://www.olympics.com/en/news/ballon-dor-2025-all-winners-all-awards-complete-list-live-updates)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 9 of 11) (https://www.peace-sport.org/news/h-s-h-prince-albert-ii-and-peace-and-sport-welcome-the-xana-foundation-winner-of-the-2025-socrates-award-in-monaco-2/)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 10 of 11) (https://www.monaco-tribune.com/en/2025/09/ballon-dor-2025-ceremony-princess-charlene-presents-socrates-prize-to-xana-foundation/)
- Socrates Award winners (added 2026-09-03, fifty-fifth intensive run): a new (source 11 of 11) (https://www.gamereactor.eu/luis-enriques-xana-foundation-named-after-his-late-daughter-wins-socrates-award-for-humanitarian-work-1605953/)
- Companion trophy sections second-pass audit (2026-10-13, Run 280): a fresh, (source 1 of 8) (https://www.si.com/soccer/kopa-trophy-list-winners-most-wins-all-time)
- Companion trophy sections second-pass audit (2026-10-13, Run 280): a fresh, (source 2 of 8) (https://www.si.com/soccer/yashin-trophy-list-winners-most-wins-all-time)
- Companion trophy sections second-pass audit (2026-10-13, Run 280): a fresh, (source 3 of 8) (https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/award-striker-of-the-year.htm)

- Companion trophy sections second-pass audit (2026-10-13, Run 280): a fresh, (source 4 of 8) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Johan_Cruyff_Trophy_(France_Football))
- Companion trophy sections second-pass audit (2026-10-13, Run 280): a fresh, (source 5 of 8) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/S%C3%B3crates_Award)
- Companion trophy sections second-pass audit (2026-10-13, Run 280): a fresh, (source 6 of 8) (https://www.peace-sport.org/news/jenni-hermoso-winner-of-the-socrates-award-at-the-2024-ballon-dor-ceremony/)
- Companion trophy sections second-pass audit (2026-10-13, Run 280): a fresh, (source 7 of 8) (https://www.monaco-tribune.com/en/2024/10/ballon-dor-2024-jenni-hermoso-first-female-winner-of-the-socrates-prize/)
- Companion trophy sections second-pass audit (2026-10-13, Run 280): a fresh, (source 8 of 8) (https://www.peace-sport.org/news/h-s-h-prince-albert-ii-and-peace-and-sport-welcome-the-xana-foundation-winner-of-the-2025-socrates-award-in-monaco-2/)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 1 of 10) (https://www.guinnessworldrecords.com/world-records/788751-oldest-winner-of-footballs-soccers-ballon-dor-award)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 2 of 10) (https://ballondor.com/news/posts/who-is-the-oldest-ballon-dor-winner)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 3 of 10) (https://ballondor.com/news/posts/who-is-the-youngest-winner-in-the-history-of-the-ballon-dor)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 4 of 10) (https://sports.yahoo.com/article/ballon-dor-oldest-player-ever-100500974.html)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 5 of 10) (https://sports.yahoo.com/article/yamal-break-record-youngest-ballon-105500980.html)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 6 of 10) (https://www.beinsports.com/en-us/soccer/articles/who-was-the-youngest-ballon-d-or-winner-2026-08-23)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 7 of 10) (https://www.si.com/soccer/the-youngest-ballon-dor-winner-ever)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 8 of 10) (https://www.givemesport.com/88101605-who-is-the-oldest-ever-ballon-dor-winner/)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 9 of 10) (https://www.oldest.org/sports/youngest-ballon-dor-winner/)
- the first vertical slice of the "Youngest winner ranking" idea (source 10 of 10) (https://www.oldest.org/sports/oldest-ballon-dor-winners/)

- Golden Boot youngest/oldest-ever winners (added 2026-10-06, (source 1 of 6) (https://sportsdigest.in/youngest-golden-boot-award-winners/195571/)
- Golden Boot youngest/oldest-ever winners (added 2026-10-06, (source 2 of 6) (https://worldsoccertalk.com/world-cup/list-of-world-cup-golden-boot-winners-every-top-scorer-from-1930-to-present/)
- Golden Boot youngest/oldest-ever winners (added 2026-10-06, (source 3 of 6) (https://www.si.com/soccer/2018/07/15/world-cup-golden-boot-award-winners-top-scorer-history)
- Golden Boot youngest/oldest-ever winners (added 2026-10-06, (source 4 of 6) (https://briefly.co.za/sports/104632-ronaldo-shatters-37-year-record-after-winning-golden-boot-euro-2020-championship/)
- Golden Boot youngest/oldest-ever winners (added 2026-10-06, (source 5 of 6) (https://yen.com.gh/sports/190306-ronaldo-shatters-37-year-record-after-winning-golden-boot-euro-2020-championship/)
- Golden Boot youngest/oldest-ever winners (added 2026-10-06, (source 6 of 6) (https://onmanorama.com/sports/football/2021/07/12/european-championships-golden-boot-winners-list-ronaldo.html)
- **EURO 1996/2020 final attendance, resolved (2026-10-17, Run 305)** (source 1 of 5) (https://datencenter.dfb.de/datencenter/europameisterschaft/1996-in-england/finale/deutschland-tschechische-republik-634569)
- **EURO 1996/2020 final attendance, resolved (2026-10-17, Run 305)** (source 2 of 5) (https://datencenter.dfb.de/en/data-center/uefa-european-championship/2020-in-europe/final/2261445)
- **EURO 1996/2020 final attendance, resolved (2026-10-17, Run 305)** (source 3 of 5) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/UEFA_Euro_1996_final)
- **EURO 1996/2020 final attendance, resolved (2026-10-17, Run 305)** (source 4 of 5) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/UEFA_Euro_2020_final)
- **EURO 1996/2020 final attendance, resolved (2026-10-17, Run 305)** (source 5 of 5) (https://www.skysports.com/football/italy-vs-england/report/421532)
- **2026 men's shortlist research (2026-10-17, Run 303)** - not added to (source 1 of 2) (https://www.si.com/soccer/ballon-dor-2026-full-list-nominees)
- **2026 men's shortlist research (2026-10-17, Run 303)** - not added to (source 2 of 2) (https://thesportscast.net/2026/09/08/2026-ballon-dor-nominees-full-list-of-30-players-nominated/)
- **Third independent cross-check of the Winners table and two superlative (source 1 of 6) (https://www.wionews.com/sports/football-french-forward-ousmane-dembele-wins-2025-ballon-d-or-spain-s-lamine-yamal-settles-for-kopa-trophy-aitana-bonmati-1758568787767/amp)

- **Third independent cross-check of the Winners table and two superlative (source 2 of 6) (https://www.si.com/soccer/ousmane-dembele-wins-2025-ballon-dor)
- **Third independent cross-check of the Winners table and two superlative (source 3 of 6) (https://thesefootballtimes.co/2017/08/23/lev-yashin-the-only-goalkeeper-to-win-the-ballon-dor/)
- **Third independent cross-check of the Winners table and two superlative (source 4 of 6) (https://global.espn.com/football/story/_/id/38742563/why-goalkeeper-never-win-ballon-dor-again)
- **Third independent cross-check of the Winners table and two superlative (source 5 of 6) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/1995_Ballon_d%27Or)
- **Third independent cross-check of the Winners table and two superlative (source 6 of 6) (https://www.90min.com/posts/ballon-d-or-1995-george-weah-delivers-football-s-greatest-individual-prize-to-africa)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 1 of 10) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/FIFA_Ballon_d%27Or)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 2 of 10) (https://bleacherreport.com/articles/1881792-how-is-the-ballon-dor-winner-selected)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 3 of 10) (https://www.si.com/soccer/2015/01/12/jurgen-klinsmann-ballon-dor-ballot-messi-ronaldo-neuer-robben)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 4 of 10) (https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/ballondor-voting.htm)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 5 of 10) (https://www.footyheadlines.com/2016/09/say-goodbye-to-fifa-ballon-dor.html)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 6 of 10) (https://www.eurosport.co.uk/football/ballon-d-or/2021/ballon-dor-2022-a-number-of-major-changes-to-award-have-been-confirmed-and-come-into-play-from-2022_sto8838643/story.shtml)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 7 of 10) (https://news.cgtn.com/news/2022-03-12/Ballon-d-Or-award-announces-rule-changes-after-controversial-Messi-win-18kQ17x3HZS/share_amp.html)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 8 of 10) (https://www.90min.com/fr/posts/revolution-les-4-changements-majeurs-que-va-subir-le-ballon-d-or)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 9 of 10) (https://www.jordannews.jo/Section-71/Football/3-Criteria-That-Decide-the-2026-Ballon-d-Or-How-Are-Nominees-Chosen-and-Who-Picks-the-Winner-55636)

- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 10 of 10) (https://foot-africa.com/en/news/ballon-dor-namibia-excluded-from-the-2025-jury-875946/)
- "Memorable moments" external-sourcing audit, and a real bug fix (source 1 of 5) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2007_Ballon_d%27Or)
- "Memorable moments" external-sourcing audit, and a real bug fix (source 2 of 5) (https://reuters.screenocean.com/record/334880)
- "Memorable moments" external-sourcing audit, and a real bug fix (source 3 of 5) (https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/ballondor-2007.htm)
- "Memorable moments" external-sourcing audit, and a real bug fix (source 4 of 5) (https://www.eurosport.co.uk/football/ballon-d-or/2022/black-history-month-how-george-weah-s-historic-1995-ballon-d-or-win-put-black-and-african-players-on_sto9192984/story.shtml)
- "Memorable moments" external-sourcing audit, and a real bug fix (source 5 of 5) (https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/ballondor-timeline.htm)
- **2026 men's winner, added (2026-10-27, Run 359)**: the 2026 Ballon d'Or (source 1 of 2) (https://www.espn.com/soccer/story/_/id/50236983/harry-kane-2026-ballon-dor-kylian-mbappe-lamine-yamal)
- **2026 men's winner, added (2026-10-27, Run 359)**: the 2026 Ballon d'Or (source 2 of 2) (https://sports.yahoo.com/articles/ballon-dor-2026-live-updates-140001627.html)
- **Kopa Trophy (best young player) - Lamine Yamal, his third consecutive (source 1 of 3) (https://sports.yahoo.com/articles/lamine-yamal-wins-2026-ballon-212900002.html)
- **Kopa Trophy (best young player) - Lamine Yamal, his third consecutive (source 2 of 3) (https://khelnow.com/football/ballon-dor-kopa-trophy-winners-202610)
- **Kopa Trophy (best young player) - Lamine Yamal, his third consecutive (source 3 of 3) (https://onefootball.com/en/news/lamine-yamal-wins-2026-ballon-dor-kopa-trophy-lennart-karl-finishes-fourth-43678222)
- **Yashin Trophy (best goalkeeper) - Unai Simón:** (source 1 of 3) (https://www.dazn.com/en-US/news/soccer/ballon-dor-2026-winners-lev-yashin-trophy-goalkeeper/1ounud7yqpyhc1keeaqfb1yanb)
- **Yashin Trophy (best goalkeeper) - Unai Simón:** (source 2 of 3) (https://khelnow.com/football/ballon-dor-yashin-trophy-winners-202610)
- **Yashin Trophy (best goalkeeper) - Unai Simón:** (source 3 of 3) (https://www.arsenal.com/news/our-2026-ballon-dor-results-in-full-aM34k3e4zgpu)
- **Gerd Müller Trophy (top scorer) - Harry Kane, his second trophy (source 1 of 3) (https://www.si.com/soccer/harry-kane-history-books-2026-gerd-muller-trophy)

- **Gerd Müller Trophy (top scorer) - Harry Kane, his second trophy (source 2 of 3) (https://khelnow.com/football/ballon-dor-gerd-muller-trophy-winners-202610)
- **Gerd Müller Trophy (top scorer) - Harry Kane, his second trophy (source 3 of 3) (https://www.pulse.com.gh/story/full-list-of-gerd-muller-trophy-winners-from-2021-2026-2026102612245031010)
- **Johan Cruyff Trophy (best coach) - Luis de la Fuente:** (source 1 of 3) (https://www.dazn.com/en-GB/news/football/ballon-dor-2026-winners-johan-cruyff-trophy-coach-of-the-year/7c3fvi1d49le1t1bv9xy76p0o)
- **Johan Cruyff Trophy (best coach) - Luis de la Fuente:** (source 2 of 3) (https://www.pulse.com.gh/story/johan-cruyff-trophy-winners-list-2024-2026-2026102612455241417)
- **Johan Cruyff Trophy (best coach) - Luis de la Fuente:** (source 3 of 3) (https://depor.com/en/us-live/2026-ballon-dor-winners-all-award-categories-and-recipients-nnda-nnrt-noticia/)
- **Sócrates Award (humanitarian) - Bukayo Saka:** (source 1 of 3) (https://sports.yahoo.com/articles/bukayo-saka-wins-socrates-award-220149187.html)
- **Sócrates Award (humanitarian) - Bukayo Saka:** (source 2 of 3) (https://www.goal.com/en/news/ballon-d-or-2026-bukayo-saka-wins-the-socrates-award-for-humanitarian-work/blt56fa02ceffa40d5f)
- **Sócrates Award (humanitarian) - Bukayo Saka:** (source 3 of 3) (https://bolavip.com/en/soccer/what-is-the-socrates-award-at-the-2026-ballon-dor)
- "First defensive midfielder since Matthäus" - Reuters-syndicated (source 1 of 5) (https://www.dailydispatch.co.za/sport/2024-10-29-spain-and-man-citys-rodri-wins-ballon-dor/)
- "First defensive midfielder since Matthäus" - Reuters-syndicated (source 2 of 5) (https://www.thestar.com.my/sport/football/2024/10/29/soccer-spain039s-rodri-wins-ballon-d039or-for-best-player-in-the-world)
- "First defensive midfielder since Matthäus" - Reuters-syndicated (source 3 of 5) (https://www.khaleejtimes.com/sports/football/manchester-citys-spanish-midfielder-rodri-wins-ballon-dor-for-best-player-in-the-world)
- "First defensive midfielder since Matthäus" - Reuters-syndicated (source 4 of 5) (https://www.timeslive.co.za/sport/soccer/2024-10-29-spain-and-man-citys-rodri-wins-ballon-dor/)
- "First defensive midfielder since Matthäus" - Reuters-syndicated (source 5 of 5) (https://www.businessday.co.za/bd/sport/soccer/2024-10-29-spain-and-man-citys-rodri-wins-ballon-dor/)
- 2023 UEFA Nations League Player of the Finals - UEFA's own site (source 1 of 2) (https://www.uefa.com/uefanationsleague/news/0282-1849de0ccdfe-e28eb8d71909-1000--rodri-named-2023-uefa-nations-league-player-of-the-finals)

- 2023 UEFA Nations League Player of the Finals - UEFA's own site (source 2 of 2) (https://www.malaymail.com/amp/news/sports/2023/06/19/rodri-named-uefa-nations-league-player-of-the-tournament/75177)
- 2024 UEFA EURO Player of the Tournament - already independently (https://businessday.ng/sports/article/euro-2024-rodri-wins-best-player-of-the-tournament)
- Paolo Rossi's 1982 World Cup/Golden Ball/Golden Boot/Ballon d'Or sweep (source 1 of 4) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Paolo_Rossi)
- Paolo Rossi's 1982 World Cup/Golden Ball/Golden Boot/Ballon d'Or sweep (source 2 of 4) (https://scroll.in/field/980819/scroll_in)
- Paolo Rossi's 1982 World Cup/Golden Ball/Golden Boot/Ballon d'Or sweep (source 3 of 4) (https://www.sportsmax.tv/studentwriters/itemlist/tag/Paolo%20Rossi)
- Paolo Rossi's 1982 World Cup/Golden Ball/Golden Boot/Ballon d'Or sweep (source 4 of 4) (https://worldfootballindex.com/2020/12/remembering-paolo-rossi-the-bolt-in-blue-vs-brazil-the-star-of-82/)
- Also checked the closest apparent rival claim, Ronaldo's 2002 World (source 1 of 2) (https://worldcupranking.com/blog/2002-world-cup-golden-boot-winner/)
- Also checked the closest apparent rival claim, Ronaldo's 2002 World (source 2 of 2) (https://www.11v11.com/ronaldo/)
- Ronaldo's 2002 World Cup/Golden Boot/Ballon d'Or treble cross-reference (source 1 of 2) (https://worldcupranking.com/blog/2002-world-cup-golden-boot-winner/)
- Ronaldo's 2002 World Cup/Golden Boot/Ballon d'Or treble cross-reference (source 2 of 2) (https://www.11v11.com/ronaldo/)
- Zinedine Zidane's 1998 World Cup/Ballon d'Or cross-reference (2026-10-30, (source 1 of 3) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/1998_Ballon_d%27Or)
- Zinedine Zidane's 1998 World Cup/Ballon d'Or cross-reference (2026-10-30, (source 2 of 3) (https://www.fotmob.com/fi/news/3u05c89ki386124keadcby01r/%27I-was-the-best-player-in-the-world%27---Zidane-reflects-on-1998-Ballon-d%27Or-win)
- Zinedine Zidane's 1998 World Cup/Ballon d'Or cross-reference (2026-10-30, (source 3 of 3) (https://english.stadiumastro.com/football/i-was-best-player-world-zidane-reflects-1998-ballon-dor-win-217026)
- Luka Modrić's 2018 World Cup Golden Ball/Ballon d'Or cross-reference (source 1 of 3) (https://www.si.com/soccer/2018/07/15/world-cup-golden-ball-luka-modric-croatia)
- Luka Modrić's 2018 World Cup Golden Ball/Ballon d'Or cross-reference (source 2 of 3) (https://www.beinsports.com/en-us/articles/luka-modric-wins-world-cup-golden-ball)
- Luka Modrić's 2018 World Cup Golden Ball/Ballon d'Or cross-reference (source 3 of 3) (https://scroll.in/field/904421/scroll_in)
- Michel Platini's 1984 EURO/Golden Boot/Ballon d'Or cross-reference (source 1 of 2) (https://theanalyst.com/2024/06/michel-platini-euro-1984/)

- Michel Platini's 1984 EURO/Golden Boot/Ballon d'Or cross-reference (source 2 of 2) (https://www.soccerway.com/news/soccer-euro-euro-rewind-the-magic-of-platini-lights-up-host-success-in-1984/x8c52o95)
- Gerd Müller's 1970 World Cup Golden Boot/Ballon d'Or cross-reference (source 1 of 3) (https://rsssf.org/miscellaneous/europa-poy70.html)
- Gerd Müller's 1970 World Cup Golden Boot/Ballon d'Or cross-reference (source 2 of 3) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Gerd_M%C3%BCller)
- Gerd Müller's 1970 World Cup Golden Boot/Ballon d'Or cross-reference (source 3 of 3) (https://worldcupranking.com/blog/1970-world-cup-golden-boot-winner/)
- Lothar Matthäus's 1990 World Cup-winning-captain/Ballon d'Or cross-reference (source 1 of 2) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Lothar_Matth%C3%A4us)
- Lothar Matthäus's 1990 World Cup-winning-captain/Ballon d'Or cross-reference (source 2 of 2) (https://fcbayern.com/en/news/2021/03/10-special-moments-in-lothar-matthaeus-career)
- Fabio Cannavaro's 2006 World Cup-winning-captain/Ballon d'Or cross-reference (source 1 of 2) (https://www.reuters.com)
- Fabio Cannavaro's 2006 World Cup-winning-captain/Ballon d'Or cross-reference (source 2 of 2) (https://www.rte.ie/sport/soccer/2006/1127/211766-cannavaro)
- Ruud Gullit's 1987 Ballon d'Or/1988 EURO-winning-captaincy cross-reference (source 1 of 2) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Ruud_Gullit)
- Ruud Gullit's 1987 Ballon d'Or/1988 EURO-winning-captaincy cross-reference (source 2 of 2) (https://www.uefa.com/uefaeuro/history/news/0253-0d7f3abb72ce-45e093ec673d-1000--ruud-gullit)
- Marco van Basten's 1988 EURO Golden Boot/Ballon d'Or cross-reference (source 1 of 2) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Marco_van_Basten)
- Marco van Basten's 1988 EURO Golden Boot/Ballon d'Or cross-reference (source 2 of 2) (https://www.uefa.com/uefaeuro/history/news/0253-0d7d771b1d5a-bab36b6c142e-1000--1988-at-a-glance/)
- Beckenbauer's 1972 Ballon d'Or (`content/ballon-dor.md`'s Winners (source 1 of 2) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/1972_Ballon_d%27Or)
- Beckenbauer's 1972 Ballon d'Or (`content/ballon-dor.md`'s Winners (source 2 of 2) (https://de.uefa.com/uefaeuro/history/news/0253-0d7de25f77f9-952295b997f7-1000--beckenbauer-leader-of-west-germany-s-glorious-class-of-72)
- Bobby Charlton's 1966 World Cup/Ballon d'Or cross-reference (2026-10-31, (source 1 of 2) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/1966_Ballon_d%27Or)
- Bobby Charlton's 1966 World Cup/Ballon d'Or cross-reference (2026-10-31, (source 2 of 2) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Bobby_Charlton)
- Lionel Messi's 2021 Copa América-winning-captaincy/Ballon d'Or (source 1 of 2) (https://en.psg.fr/teams/first-team/content/leo-messi-wins-2021-ballon-dor)

- Lionel Messi's 2021 Copa América-winning-captaincy/Ballon d'Or (source 2 of 2) (https://www.tntsports.co.uk/football/ballon-dor-2021-lionel-messi-wins-historic-seventh-award-ahead-of-robert-lewandowski-and-jorginho_sto8648942/story.shtml)

Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.